Q+A

HER PIECE OF THE ACTION

Buoyed by the critical success of her film choices, actress **PARINEETI CHOPRA** now wants to reinvent herself with every release. *Code Name: Tiranga*, her latest, sees her try her hand at action



Q. This is your first action film. They say comedy is tough to do. Is action tougher?

Comedy is still harder to do. It is all about the timing, and that is something you inherently need to have. I don't think anybody thought I could be an action figure. It is a big professional leap. The action in *Code Name* is largely hand combat, which you can't fake. Most of the men I am fighting are physically much stronger than I am, so imagine getting the punches, the kicks and the flips right! We would not shoot the sequences until I knew them with my eyes closed.

Q. Why do you think we don't see many action heroines in Bollywood?

Bollywood has wanted heroes to do certain roles and heroines a certain kind. But today, the audience is different. Covid (last two years) played a big role in upgrading people's tastes. Everybody has watched so much global content on streaming platforms that they want the same quality. Also, my director, Ribhu Dasgupta, is a Bengali and, as we know, they worship Goddess Durga. He named my character after her.

Q. With the release of *Girl on the Train*, *Sandeep aur Pinky Faraar* and *Saina*, it seemed like 2021 was a seminal year for you. What changed?

In my head, there is a Parineeti 2.0. Parineeti, the actor, now wants to shock audiences with every film. My thumb rule is that if you think I can do this film in my sleep, then I don't want to do it. There is more faith in myself. Filmmakers watched *Sandeep aur Pinky Faraar* and knew I can do something different. That's what any actor wants.

Q. With the upcoming *Uunchai*, you accomplished what's on every actor's wishlist—working with Amitabh Bachchan.

He is 80 going on 20. He is so humble and is constantly learning. He plays games, asks questions and loves social media. In front of the camera, you are just zapped by how he is doing it. It was like I was in a *gurukul*. And then there's his humility... if we were Mr Bachchan, it'd go to our heads.

with Suhani Singh

Photograph: TARAS TARAPORVALA/COSMOPOLITAN